PassFrame tuition

Synonyms & Antonyms

Year 4 Pt 2 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Worked examples — tutor talks through these first

Easy: Give a synonym for "happy".

Method & answer: glad / cheerful / pleased (any correct synonym).

Standard: Give an antonym for "ancient", and explain the difference in shade of meaning between "ancient" and the near-synonym "old".

Method & answer: Antonym = modern. "Ancient" suggests something extremely old, from a distant historical time, while "old" is a more general, everyday word for age.

Advanced: Choose the more precise synonym for "said" in this context, and explain why it fits better than a basic word: "I'm not sure," she ___ (said/murmured).

Method & answer: murmured — it suggests she spoke quietly and hesitantly, giving more detail about her tone than the plain word "said".

Easy / Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Give a synonym for "big".
2. Which word is an antonym for 'hot'? A) warm B) cold C) boiling D) mild
3. Give a synonym for "fast".
4. Give an antonym for "happy".
5. Give a synonym for "small".
6. Which word is an antonym for 'easy'? A) simple B) difficult C) plain D) basic
7. Give a synonym for "sad".
8. Give an antonym for "loud".
9. Select ALL the words below that are synonyms for 'angry': A) furious B) calm C) cross D) delighted E) annoyed
10. Give an antonym for "begin".
11. Give a synonym for "tired".
12. Which word is an antonym for 'open'? A) shut B) wide C) ajar D) unlocked
13. Give a synonym for "scared".
14. Which word is an antonym for 'wet'? A) damp B) dry C) soggy D) moist
15. Give a synonym for "clever".

Standard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Which is the best synonym for 'walked' to show someone moving slowly and sadly? A) strolled B) trudged C) dashed D) skipped
2. Give the antonym of "visible" using a prefix.
6. Give the antonym of "honest" using a prefix.
7. Which is the best synonym for 'happy' to describe someone thrilled with excitement? A) content B) ecstatic C) pleased D) satisfied
11. Which is the best synonym for 'cold' to describe freezing weather? A) cool B) chilly C) icy D) mild
12. Give the antonym of "correct" using a prefix.

3. Which is the best synonym for 'said' to show someone speaking angrily? A) whispered B) shouted C) murmured D) mentioned

4. Give the antonym of "polite" using a prefix.

5. Choose the best synonym for "big" to describe an enormous castle: (large / gigantic / sizeable)

8. Give the antonym of "patient" using a prefix.

9. Select ALL the words below that could describe someone staring in amazement: A) gazed B) glanced C) gawped D) peeked E) stared

10. Give the antonym of "comfortable" using a prefix.

13. Explain the shade of meaning difference between "glimpse" and "stare".

14. Explain the shade of meaning difference between "ancient" and "old".

15. Explain the shade of meaning difference between "delighted" and "content".

Standard / Hard — *work through together, answer 5 in the lesson* ⏱ *15 min (1 min per question)*

1. Explain the difference in connotation between "slender" and "skinny", even though both are synonyms for "thin".

2. Which is the most precise synonym for 'big' in this sentence? 'The ___ oak tree had stood for three hundred years.' A) large B) ancient C) massive D) huge

3. Explain why "hot" and "cold" are gradable antonyms, while "dead" and "alive" are complementary (non-gradable) antonyms.

4. Explain the difference in formality between "kids" and "children", and say which fits a formal school report.

6. Choose the most precise synonym for "big" in this sentence: "The ___ oak tree had stood for three hundred years." (large / ancient / massive)

7. Which statement correctly describes the difference between 'big/small' and 'open/closed'? A) Both pairs have many shades of meaning in between B) 'Big/small' are gradable with many shades in between (fairly big, quite small); 'open/closed' are more complementary, with fewer natural in-between states C) 'Open/closed' are gradable, 'big/small' are not D) Neither pair has any shades of meaning

8. Give an antonym for "generous" and explain what shade of meaning it captures compared to "mean" or "selfish".

9. Explain why "house" and "home" are not perfect synonyms, even though both refer to where someone lives.

11. Explain the difference in connotation between "curious" and "nosy", even though both describe wanting to know about something.

12. Give a synonym and an antonym for the word "brave" that fit a formal piece of writing.

13. Select ALL the statements below that correctly describe 'famous' and 'infamous': A) 'Famous' means well-known for something good. B) 'Infamous' means well-known for something good. C) 'Infamous' means well-known for something bad or shocking. D) 'Famous' and 'infamous' are exact opposites. E) Both words describe being widely known, but with different connotations.

14. Which is the most precise synonym for 'look' in: 'She ___ nervously over her shoulder.'? A) peeked B) glanced C) gazed D)

admired

5. Explain why "cheap" can have a negative connotation while "inexpensive" means the same thing but sounds more positive.

10. Which is the best synonym for 'said' in: '"I refuse," he ___ firmly.'? A) mumbled B) declared C) whispered D) mentioned

15. Explain the difference between "unique" and "unusual", and why "very unique" is considered incorrect by careful writers.